

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6 5
♥ J 9
♦ J 8 5 2
♣ Q 10 4 2

♠ A Q 8 2
♥ K Q 2
♦ Q 6 4
♣ K 7 6



♠ K 3
♥ A 10 8 6 4
♦ 10 7 3
♣ J 8 3

♠ J 10 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ A K 9
♣ A 9 5

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North
and play the ♠J, letting it ride to East's ♠K.

East cannot play ♥s without setting up your ♥Q so he will probably exit with a ♣ which you take with the ♣K.

Play off your 6 winners and concede the last three tricks.

This was almost the same as Deal 5, the difference being in which direction the ♠ finesse had to be taken.

But it sure makes a big difference in how you play the hand.

This might have turned out even better. If East had decided to play his partner for the ♥Q, (who would have played ♥J from a holding of ♥ Q J x), you would have made an overtrick!

With his 4-3-3-3 distribution South chooses not to bother with Stayman. North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥6. West plays the ♥J.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need to get two more winners. The ♥ suit might provide one of them, but you will still have to establish ♠s. The burning question is whether to win the first ♥ or to hold up. If you take this trick you will have a second stopper if East takes the lead, but you will be in extreme danger if West takes the lead. Since the ♠ finesse has to go into East you should not hold up.

You win with your ♥K, (keeping East in the dark about who holds the ♥Q), enter dummy with the ♦A

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 8 3

♥ 4

♦ J 8 7 3

♣ K 5 2

♠ 7 5 4

♥ 5 3

♦ A 9 5

♣ J 10 9 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 6

♥ K Q J 10 8 7 6

♦ 10 6 2

♣ 4

♠ A 9 2

♥ A 9 2

♦ K Q 4

♣ A Q 7 6

West

North

East

South

3♥

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

is confirmed by West's lead of the ♥4, with a doubleton he would have led a higher card. So there is no need to hold up. But . . . it couldn't hurt, could it?

Yes, it could hurt real bad! Suppose East has nothing in his hand but the ♥ K Q J 10 8 7 6 that you already know about. When you let his ♥10 win the first trick he will realize that his hand is dead. And he may be smart enough, (or lucky enough), to switch to a ♠.

The purpose of the hold-up play is to cut communications between the two defenders. So the general guideline is to hold up until you are sure one of the defenders is void in the suit - maybe twice, maybe only once, and in this case not at all.

But one of the important considerations you have to think about is the possibility that the Defense will switch to another suit - where you might be in even more trouble.

You'd feel bad on this hand if you let East hold the ♥10 only to see him next lay down the ♠J.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥4. East plays the ♥10.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=1 Total = 6

You may not agree with South's 3NT bid but how else are you going to get to the only game that has a chance of making?

You need 3 extra winners and they will come from the ♣ suit even if West holds the ♣K and wins your finesse. You may think about holding up on the ♥A for one round just to make sure West has none if he wins the ♣K.

That would be a mistake. It is almost certain that East has a 7-card ♥ suit for his preemptive opening. This

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 4
♥ A Q 10 2
♦ K 6 4
♣ K 10 8 6 3

♠ A K J 8 7 5

♥ 8 3

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A J



♠ 9 3
♥ J 9 5 4
♦ 8 7 3
♣ Q 7 4 2

♠ Q 10 6 2

♥ K 7 6

♦ A Q J 9

♣ 9 5

West

1 ♣

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

North

1 ♠

4 ♠

East

Pass

South

2 ♣